

Research Methodology Notes

Prof. Subendu Saha

05.08.2026

Meaning of Research

Research is an original contribution to the existing stock of knowledge, making for its advancement. It is the pursuit of truth with the help of study, observation, comparison and experiment.

In brief, the search for knowledge through an objective and systematic method of finding solutions to a problem is called **Research**.

The term **Research** refers to a systematic method consisting of:

- Finding the problem
- Formulating the hypothesis
- Collecting the data
- Analysing the data or facts
- Reaching conclusions either as solutions to the problem or as theoretical generalisations.

Objectives of Research

- To gain familiarity with a phenomenon or develop new ideas (Exploratory/Formulative Research).
- To accurately describe the characteristics of an individual, situation or group.
- To determine the frequency with which something occurs or is associated with something else (Diagnostic Research).
- To test hypotheses about causal relationships between variables (Hypothesis Testing).

Types of Research

Applied Research

Applied Research aims to find solutions to immediate practical problems faced by society or industry.

Fundamental (Basic) Research

Fundamental Research focuses on developing theories and generalisations. It is the pursuit of knowledge for its own sake and contributes to existing theoretical knowledge.